

experience or transact in the current form,” says Menon.

As artists struggle to salvage some of their works, multiple organisations, including Holy Water, Vandalz for Ukraine, Forze Ikonika, Ukraine DAO, and ArtWaRks Ukraine, are auctioning NFT collections for funding relief in the war-torn country.

Music and videos too: Art NFTs are not restricted to images but also extend to music and videos. In 2021, the background score of the film *Triumph* was launched as an NFT. American rapper Snoop Dogg is collaborating with Clay Nation to launch some of his unreleased music and limited-edition pitches as NFTs on the Cardano (ADA) blockchain. When you read this story, South Indian playback singer Karthik would have launched his first collection of music NFTs on India’s first fully-curated NFT marketplace, Jupiter Meta, through his special metaverse solo concert on April 14, 2022.

Twitter, Instagram, and YouTube are all planning to integrate NFT features. In a blog post about the company’s Web3 plans for 2022, YouTube mentioned introducing NFT and blockchain features to allow creators to build deeper relationships with fans and monetise their creations, while also providing fans an opportunity to own unique content. Twitter has been experimenting with hexagonal profile pictures to use NFT avatars. It will also bring in NFT authentication features along with Bitcoin and other crypto-payment systems.

Collectibles of every imaginable kind

Collectibles and memorabilia of every kind are floating around in NFT marketplaces—and pretty strange ones too. People buy NFTs of newspaper clippings, magazine covers, tweets, and memes. They buy GIFs featuring tacos, toilet paper, and cards. They buy NFT trading cards featuring key moments from the sporting world, and

The hidden charges

Reading about all this makes every other person eager to try their luck in minting NFTs! With mobile apps like Sketchar, you can even create NFTs on-the-go, right? While technically speaking anyone can mint an NFT, practically it is not so easy. First, you need a wallet, and it needs to be loaded with crypto, even to mint and sell an NFT. Most sites charge for buying and selling—very few let you list an NFT for free, and then charge a commission on the sale price. Along with this, many marketplaces also charge a ‘gas fee’ to compensate the energy consumed to complete the transaction, considering that it is an extremely energy-intensive process.

Add to this the conversion fees charged by crypto-exchanges to convert your money into cryptocurrencies, the rapid fluctuations that the crypto-market is known for, and the need for a reasonably advanced computer system to mint an NFT, and you might just end up spending more than you bargained for.

Buying NFTs is also not easy—at least not the ones with high potential—because many NFT drops are by invite. To get into one, you need to be active on the project’s or creator’s social media, and garner enough attention to be considered worth being in the White List.

or milestones from the lives of their favourite actors or musicians. Note that much of this, like Jack Dorsey’s first tweet or a football top shot, is already available on the Web for all to see. Why would people spend money on collecting such NFTs?

To answer this, ask yourself why people have historically collected seemingly small-value things like stamps, scale models, and sports trading cards. Well, the logic behind a collection is that its value increases

over a period of time. When stamps go out of print, their value increases. Trading cards with MS Dhoni or Virat Kohli can be bought off shelves today for an insignificant price, but some years later, when cards with other faces fill the shelves, these will become scarce and valuable!

Then there is the hero worship aspect too. Fans want to own a piece of their hero’s journey—like buying the ball that went for a winning sixer, or the sneakers that an athlete wore while winning a key race. They want to collect trivia and trinkets associated with their favourite brands.

So, people buy NFT collectibles hoping that scarcity and fan-following will increase the value of these collectibles in the secondary market.

Brand marvels: Taco Bell launched a collection of taco-themed GIFs and Pizza Hut sold pixelated pizzas, while Charmin sold non-fungible toilet paper, and TIME Magazine auctioned NFTs of some of its famous covers! Adidas debuted NFTs in December 2021 and sold \$23 million worth within hours. Some of their ‘Into the Metaverse’ NFTs purchased at \$765 at drop are now selling for over \$2500 on OpenSea. Mahindra & Mahindra launched a collection of



Figure 4: An NFT from Adidas’ Into the Metaverse collection (Source: Adidas)